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Victory! Austin Organizers Cancel City's Flock ALPR Contract

Austin organizers turned out to rebuke the city's misguided contract with Flock Safety— and won. This successful pushback from the community means at the end of the month Austin police will no longer be able to use the surveillance network of automated license plate readers (ALPRs) across the city.

Two years ago [Austin City Council approved](#) this controversial contract, despite strong local opposition. We knew then that these AI-driven surveillance systems weren't just creepy, they are prone to [misuse](#) and [mistakes](#) which have [a real human toll](#).

In the years since, this concern has materialized [time and time again](#), and now the risks have heightened with the potential of using the data against immigrants and people seeking trans or reproductive healthcare. Most recently Texas authorities were implicated in a [404 media report](#) on the use of these cameras to [target abortion seekers](#).

Today's victory in Austin is a tribute to what happens when a coalition of

activist groups come together in common cause

Just a few days before the scheduled vote, an [audit of the Austin Police Department](#) program also revealed that over 20% of ALPR database searches lacked proper documentation or justification, in violation of department policy. The audit also revealed contract language allowed for data retention beyond [council-mandated limits](#) on retention and potential sharing with outside agencies.

Fortunately, more than 30 community groups, including [Electronic Frontier Alliance](#) member [EFF-Austin](#), joined forces to [successfully prevent contract renewal](#).

EFF-Austin Executive Director Kevin Welch told us that, "Today's victory in Austin is a tribute to what happens when a coalition of activist groups come together in common cause and stand in solidarity against the expansion of the surveillance state." He went on to say, "But the fight is not over. While the Flock contract has been discontinued, Austin still makes use of ALPRs via its contract with Axon, and [the] council may attempt to bring this technology back [...] That being said, real progress in educating elected officials on the dangers of these technologies has been made."

This win in a city as large as Austin lends momentum to the [larger trend across the country](#) where local communities are pushing back against ALPR surveillance. EFF continues to stand with these local efforts, and encourages other organizers to reach out at organizing [at] eff.org in the fight against local surveillance.

Speaking to this trend, Kevin added, "As late as Monday, it didn't look like we had the votes to make this victory happen. While these are dark times, there are still lights burning in the dark, and through collective action, we can burn bright."

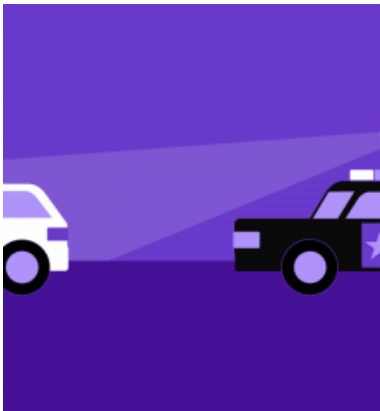


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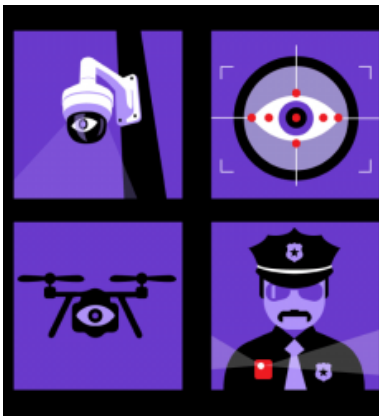
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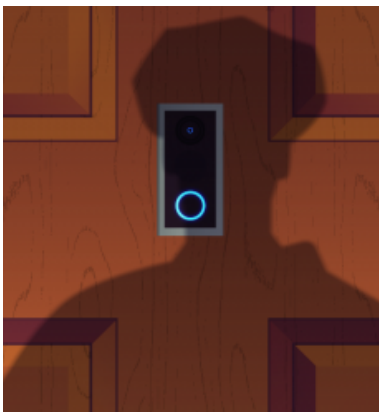
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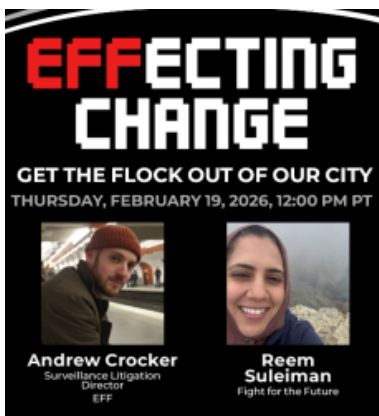
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